James Spooner

GIS Specialist

CONTACT

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Vancouver, Canada

SKILLS

GIS software

ArcGIS Pro, ArcGIS Online, Field Maps, Survey123, QuickCapture, Dashboards, QGIS, cartography and map design

Data and programming

PostgreSQL / PostGIS, SQL, Python / ArcPy, ArcGIS API for Python, ModelBuilder, Power Automate, spatial and data analysis

Remote sensing

LiDAR processing, DTM / DSM / CHM, tree detection, volumetric modelling

Ways of working

Community engagement, co-design, training and documentation, data governance (OCAP)

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Geography
University of Brighton, 2013–2016

International Baccalaureate
Dartford Grammar School, 2006–2013

VOLUNTEERING

Coordinator, Parque Machía
Villa Tunari, Bolivia, 2019

REFERENCES

Available on request.

PROFILE

GIS Specialist who builds asset management and maintenance systems with First Nations communities, and trains local teams to run them. Five years of experience across Canada, the UK, and South Africa, from field data collection and spatial analysis to dashboards, automation, and cartography.

EXPERIENCE

GIS Specialist · Tapestry Research Group — Jan 2025 – Present · Vancouver

- Lead the design and build of asset management and maintenance systems for remote First Nations communities.
- Turn field inspections and resident reports into tracked work orders, so nothing falls through the cracks.
- Give staff and leadership live dashboards showing the condition of their housing and infrastructure.
- Automate routine data work so systems stay accurate without extra effort from staff.
- Co-write asset management plans and the manuals staff rely on day to day.
- Work alongside Chief and Council, Elders, and staff, and train local teams to run their own systems.
- Produce maps and atlases that help communities plan for and tell the story of their territory.

GIS Analyst · Ringway — Mar 2022 – Aug 2024 · London

- Scored above 95% in every KPI audit for efficiency and work order closure, and helped clear around 80% of outstanding work to cut project backlogs.
- Turned complex datasets into clear maps, charts, and reports that teams used to plan and prioritize work.
- Kept project databases accurate, and built Excel reporting that cut time spent on routine tasks.

GIS Technician · Cyient — Nov 2021 – Mar 2022 · London

- Mapped and maintained land parcel data used to distribute farm subsidies for the Rural Payments Agency.
- Classified habitats from satellite and aerial imagery to check whether subsidy claims were valid, consistently beating QA targets.

GIS Intern · Wildlife & Ecological Investments — Jul 2021 – Oct 2021 · South Africa

- Mapped habitats across Gondwana Game Reserve from satellite imagery, and related endangered species numbers to the landscape.
- Ran hot spot analysis that showed the anti-poaching unit where to focus its patrols.

EARLIER ROLES

Admissions Officer · London South Bank University — Oct 2020 – Jun 2021

- Managed large applicant datasets accurately and in line with policy, and improved processing from submission to final decision.

Market Research · MBI — Jan 2018 – Dec 2018, Jan 2020 – Sep 2020

- Cleaned and maintained research databases, spotting trends that supported reporting and decision-making.

Community Associate · IWG — Apr 2019 – Nov 2019

- Managed client records and daily operations as the main point of contact in a busy workspace.